

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Bengal before 1756: successor state and sovereignty conflict

BENGAL -> wealthy Mughal successor state, not a political vacuum

1717 FARMAN -> bounded privilege for Company trade | DASTAK ABUSE -> servants' private trade

FORTIFICATION + customs + jurisdiction -> commercial dispute becomes sovereignty dispute

SIRAJ 1756 -> inherits court rivalry and a Company testing Nawabi authority.

MUST REMEMBER: Plassey on 23 June 1757, Buxar on 22 October 1764, the 1765 Allahabad settlement and Diwani grant, and the 1765-72 Dual Government are separate stages.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Calcutta crisis and the Black Hole caution

UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION -> Kasimbazar seized -> Fort William falls in June 1756

CLIVE / WATSON -> Calcutta recovered -> Alinagar -> Chandernagore removed as counterweight

BLACK HOLE -> Holwell is an interested, weakly corroborated narrator

RULE -> never make a disputed body count or atrocity story the causal centre of conquest.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Plassey's hidden battle: conspiracy and collaboration

COMPANY / CLIVE -> regime-change plan + secret correspondence + coercive leverage
MIR JAFAR -> throne | JAGAT SETH -> credit and security | RAI DURLABH -> office
AMICHAND -> broker later deceived | MIR MADAN / MOHAN LAL -> loyal resistance
VERDICT -> interests explain collaboration better than a one-word betrayal morality tale.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Plassey and the Mir Jafar client regime

PLASSEY, 23 JUNE 1757 -> conspiracy neutralises most Nawabi command

RESULT -> Mir Jafar installed; Company becomes kingmaker and gains political entry

CLIENT CYCLE -> dependence -> transfers / concessions -> deeper Company leverage

LIMIT -> Plassey changed the ruler; it did not yet grant legal-fiscal sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Mir Qasim: reform, equality and conflict

MIR QASIM 1760 -> shifts capital to Munger + strengthens administration and army

COMPANY PRIVATE TRADE -> duty privilege distorts competition and weakens Nawabi revenue

RESPONSE 1763 -> abolish inland duties for all traders: equality, not modern nationalism

COMPANY RESISTS LOST ADVANTAGE -> war -> Mir Qasim seeks an Awadh-Mughal coalition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Buxar: coalition breadth versus unified Company command

COALITION -> Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daula + Shah Alam II; distinct motives

STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS -> separate treasuries, commands and political objectives

COMPANY -> Hector Munro's integrated command, supply and payment system

BUXAR, 22 OCTOBER 1764 -> open military supremacy, unlike Plassey's palace coup.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Three-stage conquest thesis

PLASSEY 1757 -> POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking

BUXAR 1764 -> MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated

ALLAHABAD / DIWANI 1765 -> LEGAL-FISCAL TITLE: revenue authority institutionalised

RULE -> Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Allahabad, Diwani, Nizamat and the Awadh buffer

SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT -> Company receives Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa

SHUJA-UD-DAULA SETTLEMENT -> Awadh restored as a strategic buffer, not annexed

DIWANI -> revenue / civil side | NIZAMAT -> nominal police, criminal and military side

CAUTION -> Diwani was not Nawabship and the legal split was not equal power-sharing.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Dual Government: power separated from responsibility

1765-72 -> Company holds revenue power through Indian deputies

NAWAB'S ESTABLISHMENT -> nominal Nizamat and public responsibility without resources

PARADOX -> Company power without responsibility / Nawab responsibility without power

RESULT -> extraction incentives + diffused accountability + weak corrective capacity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Famine, accountability and the 1772 termination

1770 FAMINE -> harvest failure / drought and disease create the natural shock

DUAL GOVERNMENT -> revenue rigidity and administrative confusion amplify vulnerability

CAUTION -> Company policy mattered but did not alone cause drought or the catastrophe

HASTINGS 1772 -> ends Dual Government; direct administration bridges to Topic 06.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance; Buxar established a broader military-fiscal superiority against Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah Alam II.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Company-state, early drain mechanism and historiography

TRADE PRIVILEGE -> kingmaking -> Diwani -> revenue funds purchases and armies

INDIAN AGENCY -> collaboration, resistance and administration operate under unequal power

LENSES -> nationalist extraction | collaboration | corporate-fiscal state | Bengal continuity

2026 MEMORY ANCHOR -> revisit Plassey beyond betrayal; static causation remains book-grounded.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Company records and later nationalist accounts must be checked against Bengal court, banking and revenue evidence; conquest was contingent, collaborative and coercive.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 04 answer spine and boundaries

OPEN -> sovereignty conflict over privilege, private trade, fortification and jurisdiction
TRACE -> conspiracy / client regime -> reform and war -> Buxar -> Diwani -> Dual Government
WEIGH -> collaboration + Company capacity; famine is multicausal; reject false precision
CLOSE -> 1772 ends this topic; expansion and 1773+ regulation pass to Topics 05-06.